

MINUTES OF MEETING HELD January 23rd, 2024 OF GRADUATE AND PROFESSIONAL STUDENT COUNCIL, GENERAL COUNCIL

A meeting of the Graduate and Professional Student Council (GPSC), General Council was convened on Tuesday, January 23rd, 2024 at 6:30 PM held exclusively on [ZOOM](#)

Present at the meeting were the following members of the:

GPSC Executive Board:

Samuel David Jesse, Peter Echieh, Ahana Singh, Jeremy Bernick, Lacey Cigan

GPSC General Council:

Olga Vasylenko, Alex Acuna, Miguel Meza Balbin, Rishabh Bhonsle, Milad Hasankhani, Divya Jeyasingh, Jennifer Gwasira, Emilia Banuelos, Sydni Fomas Do, Joanna Joseph, Kennedy Sparling, Noah Simmons, Karen Jacquez, Ciara Garcia, Joshua Liberman, Diana Avdeeva, Garrett Reichenbach, Matt Danley, MJ Tribble, Dr. Masango, Kristen Gregory, Jennie Rose Weiss

Guests

Sabina Iturralde

Proxies:

Jeremy Bernick for Maya Braun Yoon

Quorum met: **28 of 36** council members present

The meeting was called to order at **6:31 PM** and was adjourned at **7:23 PM**:

1. Call to Order

a. Meeting was called to order at **6:31 PM**.

b. Land Acknowledgement

We respectfully acknowledge the University of Arizona is on the land and territories of Indigenous peoples. Today, Arizona is home to 22 federally recognized tribes, with Tucson being home to the O'odham and the Yaqui. Committed to diversity and inclusion, the University strives to build sustainable relationships with sovereign Native Nations

and Indigenous communities through education offerings, partnerships, and community service.

2. Call to Audience

- a. Jeremy: welcomes all reps and acknowledges the negative news coming out of the U of A financial crisis. Reach out to him if you have any questions regarding the matter
- b. Samuel: Election will be held for Sabina Iturralde

3. Approval of Minutes, as submitted by the Secretary

- i. December 2023 GC Meeting Approved, submitted by secretary on 1/23/2023
 - 1. Samuel moves to approve the motion, Jeremy seconds the motion
- ii. Lacey and Maya responsible for creating previous meeting minutes
- iii. Some meeting (August EB and GC) has been lost due to Zoom's policy of holding recordings for 130 days.

4. President's Report

- i. Graduate college is cutting funding for several GPSC positions:
 - ii. President 0.5 to 0.25 FTE
 - iii. Events Director 0.25 FTE to 0.00 FTE
 - iv. Has already been reduced from 0.5 to 0.25 FTE this year
- ii. Working with Secretary of State in April to do a "get out there and vote" for graduate students
 - i. Working to get a new provost for the university that considers issues of the graduate students
 - ii. Provide the EB with information about graduate stipends
 - iii. Graduate fees are going to be removed starting next semester for anyone working as a TA/RA

5. Treasurer's Report

- a. Will be sending out information to process out the third quarter of stipends

6. Additional Reports & Summaries

- a. Officers:
 - i. Administrative VP

1. Representative Reports
 - i. Candidate for special election for college of education
 - ii. Remaining Vacancies
 1. GIDP
 2. Education
 3. Fine Arts
 4. Management
 5. Nursing
 6. SBS
 - iii. If you are yet to meet with me, text me!
2. Responsibility for Duties
 - a. Attend GC meetings (or get proxy 48+ hours in advance)
 - b. Serve 1 internal and 1 external committee
 - c. Meet with dean 1/semester
 - d. Meet with constituents 1/year
 - i. Budget of \$15-25 per representative per meeting
 - ii. Total of \$500
 - iii. Reimbursement through graduate college or coordinate with events director (Pranit Patil)
 - iv. Serve as GPSC travel grant 1/year
 - v. Submit Representative Report 1/year
 1. Due 1/19/2023, still missing 21
3. Basic Needs Benefit Dinner
 - a. Allocation of \$2000 in our budget to donate to campus pantry
 - b. We reserve 3 tables or 24 people
 - c. RSVP by EOD Feb 2nd, 2024.
4. GPSC Website
 - a. Currently been updated by Christina
 - b. If you like changes, cc Christina and Samuel
5. Running for Elections 2024
 - a. If you are current officer, you need to re-run

- b. More details to be available, looking to have elections earlier this year
 - ii. Executive VP (Jeremy on behalf of Maya)
 - a. Menstrual Equity Initiative
 - i. Period products to be available in all first floor restrooms (women's and all gender) with the exception of residence halls and student union, starting late January
 - ii. Meeting this week with the head of student union to have the products in the student union and the rec center
 - b. Doxing policy
 - i. Working with faculty senate and members of President's cabinet to address incidents of abuse/doxing by the professors towards student/students
 - c. Hiring elections director on handshake
 - iii. Secretary
 - 1. None at the time
 - iv. Assembly Chair
 - 1. Proposed schedule for meetings for this semester has been sent out by the assembly chair via email
 - b. Representatives:
 - i. None at this Time
 - c. Staff:
 - i. None at this Time.
- 7. Internal Committee Reports**
- a. Appropriations
 - i. No new updates
 - b. Policy
 - i. No new updates
 - c. Governing Documents Committee

- i. If you have any alterations send it Ahana
- d. Social & Marketing
 - 1. GPSC Social & Marketing first meeting on 1/25/2024 at 7pm
 - 2. Updates about the grad night in the newsletter
- e. Ad-hoc Committees
 - i. Graduate Orientation Planning (Jennie)
 - ii. Graduate-Faculty Review (Jeremy)
 - 1. Cultural problem of abuse by faculties, no grievance policy
 - 2. Partnered with faculty senate to co-chair this committee including the doxing policy
 - 3. Met with Chief Safety Officer at UofA interested in new services/interfaces and reporting mechanisms to help in terms of confidentiality
 - 4. Working on a final report and MoU with graduate college
 - 5. Interested to reach out to either Sonia Kauffman/Jeremy
- 8. External Committee Reports**
 - a. Peter attended Graduate Council Committee meeting
 - b. Student Health Insurance Advocacy Committee to have second meeting next week and looking optimistic to include dental insurance going forward. Routine hygiene/maintenance need to pay \$10-15, not confirmed.
- 9. Old Business**
 - a. None at this Time
- 10. New Business**
 - i. Special elections for College of Education Representative
 - b. Motion (as proposed by the Assembly Chair): I move to elect Sabrina Iturralde as the college of education representative.
 - i. Seconded by President Jeremy Bernick
 - ii. Motion carried without dissent.
 - c. Sabrina Iturralde swearing-in.
- 11. Constituency Concerns**

- a. Jeremy: ASU partners with OpenAI and asks the council if we should also implement it for UofA and form an ad-hoc committee to talk about issues in AI and higher education
- b. A small team of reps to be accountable for keeping track of what all the departments are doing when it comes to graduate students

12. Motion to Adjourn

- a. Motion to adjourn meeting by the Samuel David Jesse
 - i. Seconded by Jeremy Bernick
 - ii. Motion carried without dissent
 - iii. Meeting adjourned at **7:23 PM**

Legal Actions proposed, discussed, or taken:

- Motion (as proposed by the Secretary): I move to adjourn the meeting.
 - Seconded by Rep. John W.W. Powell
 - Motion carried without dissent.
- Motion (as proposed by the Assembly Chair): I move to elect Sabrina Iturralde as the college of education representative.
 - Seconded by President Jeremy Bernick
 - Motion carried without dissent.

Dated this **23rd** day of **January 2024**

Graduate and Professional Student Council Executive Board

Ahana Singh, Secretary